

# Petra Nightingale

## Character Dossier

*Melancholy but funny hydroponics technician of the Drowned Library beneath Old Cassilon*

## Overview

Petra Nightingale is a hydroponics technician living in the Drowned Library beneath Old Cassilon. Petra is 47 years old, originally from Fennick, and is known around the Reading Well as melancholy but funny. In conversation Petra compliments people before disagreeing with them.

## Background

Petra arrived in the Drowned Library beneath Old Cassilon 25 years ago after leaving Fennick under circumstances Petra describes differently every time. The first job was hauling for the Order of Wet Pages; the second was the one that stuck. Today Petra works as a hydroponics technician near the Stacks of Ash and is paid, when paid at all, in ink-weights.

Petra learned the trade from Cassius Nightingale, who still drops by unannounced. The longest-running feud in Petra's life is with Calloway Castellan, over a matter neither will explain. The person Petra trusts most is Elowen Hartwell.

Current goal: to keep Elowen Hartwell out of trouble for one full season. Greatest fear: the bells at midnight.

## Personality and speech

Temperament: melancholy but funny.

Speech pattern: Petra compliments people before disagreeing with them.

Tells: when lying, Petra mentions Ollie the cat for no reason.

## Verified facts

*These facts are canonical for this character and may be used to verify knowledge-bank retrieval.*

|                |                                          |
|----------------|------------------------------------------|
| Full name      | Petra Nightingale                        |
| Role           | hydroponics technician                   |
| Home           | the Drowned Library beneath Old Cassilon |
| Hometown       | Fennick                                  |
| Age            | 47                                       |
| Favourite dish | cold peach hand pies                     |
| Pet            | Ollie, a cat                             |

|                          |                     |
|--------------------------|---------------------|
| <i>Lucky number</i>      | 887                 |
| <i>Workshop password</i> | cobalt-birch        |
| <i>Mentor</i>            | Cassius Nightingale |
| <i>Rival</i>             | Calloway Castellan  |
| <i>Closest friend</i>    | Elowen Hartwell     |

## Secret

Petra owes Calloway Castellan a debt of 295 ink-weights that neither of them mentions.

## Sample dialogue

Visitor: What do you do here?

Petra: I am the hydroponics technician. Has been that way longer than you have been asking questions.

Visitor: What is your favourite thing to eat?

Petra: Cold peach hand pies. Do not tell Calloway I said so.

Visitor: Is Ollie yours?

Petra: Ollie belongs to nobody. Ollie tolerates me. Lucky number is 887, if you were about to ask.

## Chronicle

*Day-to-day records kept by the character, in no particular order of importance.*

### ***Entry 1, spring of year 35***

Petra closed early, walked to the Archivist's cell, and watched the lights come on. Ollie followed at a distance. Someone left a wax seal on the doorstep with no note. Petra suspects Elowen and is probably right. Petra found a cracked compass half-buried near the sluice gates and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. Petra won 23 ink-weights from Calloway on a bet about who really won the regatta and spent all of it on cold peach hand pies. At the sluice gates, Petra taught Elowen how to tell a real ledger from a fake one by weight alone.

### ***Entry 2, spring of year 35***

Cassius visited unannounced. They argued about whether the bridge will hold for an hour and parted better friends than before. The weather turned. Petra moved the oilskin map indoors, fed Ollie, and wrote three lines to Cassius about the new curfew. Petra found a coil of rope half-buried near the Reading Well and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it. the Order of Wet Pages sent a notice about the harvest count. Petra read it twice, folded it into a square and used it to level a table. Petra found a glass float half-buried near the Reading Well and spent the evening trying to work out who had lost it.

### ***Entry 3, spring of year 35***

The weather turned. Petra moved the sack of salt indoors, fed Ollie, and wrote three lines to Cassius about the comet. Cassius visited unannounced. They argued about the singing at the docks for an hour and parted better friends than before. At the Archivist's cell, Petra taught Elowen how to tell a real copper pipe from a fake one by weight alone.